in small, badly lit rooms without ventilation. The local bosses operate on narrow margins and pass this pressure along to the workers, who suffer repression and even the murder of trade unionists. This situation burst into the international news when 250 people died after a factory lacking labour protections collapsed. Many journalists drew analogies between these current subhuman working conditions and those present in England during the industrial revolution.[36]

Conclusion

China has risen to become a central global economy. The historic leap in industrialisation allowed it to play a previously unimaginable international role in rescuing the financial system. But it has so far failed to make the shift to domestic consumption. Its substitution of commercial reforms with capitalism has generated over-investment, bank speculation and social polarisation. Global economic expansion began to hinder China's defensive geopolitical strategy, accentuating disputes between coastal and interior elites. The restoration of capitalism is extremely advanced, but it has not been completed. Meanwhile, competing tendencies for cooperation and conflict with the United States persist.

The intermediate economies have grown, but are located on a lower rung. Various regional sub-powers with ambitions to become sub-imperialist powers have regained influence, but have not forged common blocs. These countries operate within the neoliberal order and it is wrong to characterise them by using short-term financial criteria. Russia rebuilt its state when faced with oligarchic plundering in order to stabilise accumulation, erecting a contentious obstacle for NATO. India's growth lags far behind, compared to China's development, in a region crisscrossed with military conflicts. In a framework marked by high unemployment and inequality, the co-optation of a post-apartheid black elite has made it possible for South Africa to project itself. Turkey's neo-Ottoman expansionism undergirds its own neoliberal growth.

The global income gap continues to widen, impoverishing the periphery. Malnutrition is accentuated by rising food prices generated by the capitalist restructuring of agriculture. Black capitalism stands out in Africa after a period of bloody wars for the spoils of natural resources. New powers are now intervening and the local elites are enriching themselves. The Arab world continues to suffer high levels of exploitation while in Asia this process can even be characterised as super-exploitation.

Poverty, unemployment, infamously low wages, and super-exploitation mark the periphery with the neoliberal period's deepest scars.